Language Usage practice booklet: Grade 7 expectations

Grade 7 · Practice booklet

Name: _____

What this booklet is

This is general practice written for Language Usage at Grade 7 level, following the Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts standards for that grade. It is not made from your child's MAP questions, and it does not replace the classroom. Use it as a guide to what a child is expected to know and do at this level.

How to use it

- Do one section at a time, about 10 minutes, 3 days a week. Stop while it is still enjoyable.
- Read each question all the way through, twice, before answering. Underline the key words and say what is being asked.
- Take your time. A careful, correct answer is worth more than a fast one.
- Use scrap paper and show the working. Then check the answer before moving on.
- Ask your child to explain how they got an answer, even when it is right.
- If a section feels too hard, do the section before it again, or ask the teacher. That is part of learning, not a problem.

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

Standards practised: L.7.2, L.7.2a, L.7.2b

A worked example

Correct this sentence: the long dusty road to the hajar mountains was empty so we stopped for karak

1. Capital letters: The (first word) and the place name Hajar Mountains.
2. Long and dusty are coordinate adjectives: each one describes the road on its own, and you could say 'dusty and long road'. Put a comma between them: long, dusty road.
3. A comma goes before 'so' because it joins two complete sentences: ... was empty, so we stopped for karak.
4. End with a full stop.

The long, dusty road to the Hajar Mountains was empty, so we stopped for karak.

Questions

1. Add the comma that is needed: Salem climbed the steep rocky path to the top of the hill.

2. Does this sentence need a comma between the adjectives? Write it correctly: Hind carried a small leather bag to the souq.

3. Add the comma: The metro was crowded so Omar stood near the door.

4. Which spelling is correct: definately, definitely or definitly?

5. Choose the right word: The hot weather had a big (affect / effect) on how many people came to the beach.

6. Choose the right word: Noura (accepted / excepted) the invitation to the Eid lunch.

7. Correct the capital letters: my uncle took us to the hajar mountains in january.

8. Punctuate it: Layla asked Can I help you carry the dates

9. Which spelling is correct: occured, occurred or ocurred?

10. Choose the right word: The camel lifted (its / it's) head and looked across the dunes.

11. Find and correct the spelling mistake: The desalination plant provides neccessary water for the city.

12. Write one sentence about the souq that uses two coordinate adjectives, and say how you tested them.

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

Standards practised: L.7.1, L.7.1a, L.7.1b, L.7.1c, L.7.3, L.7.3a

A worked example

Name the kind of sentence: Although the market was crowded, Noura found the dates, and she paid quickly.

1. Find the clauses. 'Although the market was crowded' has a subject and verb but cannot stand alone (dependent). 'Noura found the dates' and 'she paid quickly' each can stand alone (independent).
2. Two independent clauses make it compound, and one or more dependent clauses make it complex.
3. It has both, so it is compound-complex.

compound-complex

Questions

1. Is 'after the long drive' a phrase or a clause? Give a reason.

2. Copy the independent clause (the part that can stand alone): When the sun rose, the fishermen left the harbour.

3. Say whether the sentence is simple, compound, complex or compound-complex: Maryam likes karak, and Omar likes juice.

4. Say whether the sentence is simple, compound, complex or compound-complex: Because the road was closed, Salem took the metro.

5. Say whether the sentence is simple, compound, complex or compound-complex: Hamdan and Layla walked along the creek at sunset.

6. Fix the misplaced modifier: Salem saw a falcon flying over the dunes with his binoculars.

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7. Fix the dangling modifier: Walking into the souq, the spices smelled wonderful.

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8. Combine into one complex sentence, using 'because': Omar was tired. He had walked all day in the Hajar Mountains.

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9. Make this sentence more concise without losing its meaning: Due to the fact that it was raining, we stayed inside.

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10. Choose the more precise word: The falcon (went / swooped) down onto the lure.

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11. Explain why this is a fragment and fix it: Because the bus was late.

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12. Write a compound-complex sentence about a trip to the beach, and mark the independent and dependent clauses.

Section 3: Writing

Standards practised: W.7.1, W.7.1a, W.7.1b, W.7.2, W.7.2a, W.7.3, W.7.3a, W.7.4, W.7.5

A worked example

Plan the start of an argument: should children in the UAE walk or cycle to school when the distance is short? Write a claim and two reasons with evidence.

1. Write a clear claim that takes a side: Children who live close to school should walk or cycle.
2. Reason 1 with evidence: it keeps them active. Evidence: walking ten minutes each way adds twenty minutes of exercise a day.
3. Reason 2 with evidence: it cuts traffic outside the school gate. Evidence: fewer cars means shorter queues in the morning.
4. Plan one sentence that answers the other side (for example, the heat) and a closing sentence that repeats the claim.

Claim: Children who live close to school should walk or cycle. Reason 1: it keeps them active (twenty minutes of exercise a day). Reason 2: it cuts traffic at the gate (shorter queues). Other side: it can be hot, but early mornings and shaded paths make it comfortable. Closing: Walking or cycling is good for children and for the whole school community.

Questions

1. Which is the stronger claim for an argument? (a) Mangroves are interesting. (b) The UAE should plant more mangroves because they protect the coast.

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2. Write a claim and two reasons for this topic: Schools should plan one outdoor lesson each week.

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3. Which piece of evidence best supports the claim 'Solar parks are good for the UAE'? (a) Solar parks are big. (b) A solar park can make clean electricity for thousands of homes without burning fuel. (c) My cousin visited one.

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4. Write one sentence that acknowledges an opposing view and then answers it: Your claim is that the school day should start early.

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5. Which sentence is the best topic sentence for an informative paragraph about the Hope Probe? (a) The Hope Probe is cool. (b) The Hope Probe is a spacecraft from the UAE that studies the atmosphere of Mars. (c) I saw it on the news.

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6. Add a transition to join the two sentences so the second adds a new point: Dates give quick energy. ____ they contain fibre that helps digestion.

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7. Cross out the sentence that does not belong in a paragraph about how the Dubai Metro works: (1) Trains run on a track above and below the ground. (2) Passengers tap a card at the gate. (3) My brother likes football. (4) Trains arrive every few minutes.

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8. Revise this sentence to be formal and precise: The weather was kind of bad and stuff, so lots of people didn't come.

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9. Plan the start of a narrative. Write a character, a setting, a problem and one sentence of dialogue to use this opening: Maryam opened the old wooden chest.

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10. Revise to add sensory detail: The market was busy.

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11. Revise the ending of this paragraph to restate the main idea without adding a new fact: Camels store fat in their humps. They can go many days without water. They are well suited to desert life.

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12. A friend's draft argues that children should have less homework, but gives only the reason 'because it is boring'. Explain two ways to improve it.

Answer guide for parents

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

1. Salem climbed the steep, rocky path to the top of the hill. (steep and rocky are coordinate adjectives: you can swap them or put 'and' between them)
2. No comma: Hind carried a small leather bag to the souq. (you cannot say 'leather small bag' or 'small and leather bag', so the adjectives are not coordinate)
3. The metro was crowded, so Omar stood near the door. (a comma goes before 'so' when it joins two complete sentences)
4. definitely
5. effect (here it is a noun meaning a result; affect is usually a verb meaning to change something)
6. accepted (it means said yes; excepted means left out)
7. My uncle took us to the Hajar Mountains in January. (the first word, a place name and a month all begin with capital letters; uncle stays lower case after 'my')
8. Layla asked, "Can I help you carry the dates?" (a comma before the quotation, a capital letter to begin the speech, and the question mark inside the quotation marks)
9. occurred (the final r is doubled before -ed)
10. its (it's means 'it is' or 'it has'; here the head belongs to the camel)
11. necessary (one c and two s's)
12. A good answer has a comma between two adjectives that each describe the noun alone, and a test: the adjectives can be swapped or joined with 'and'. Model: The souq was a busy, noisy place in the evening. (busy and noisy place, and noisy, busy place, both sound right)

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

1. A phrase: it has no subject and verb of its own.
2. the fishermen left the harbour (When the sun rose is a dependent clause)
3. compound (two independent clauses joined by a comma and 'and')
4. complex (one dependent clause and one independent clause)
5. simple (one independent clause, even though it has two subjects)
6. With his binoculars, Salem saw a falcon flying over the dunes. (the binoculars belong with Salem, not with the falcon)
7. Walking into the souq, Maryam smelled the wonderful spices. (any correct answer names a person who is walking right after the comma; the spices cannot walk)
8. Model: Omar was tired because he had walked all day in the Hajar Mountains. (the dependent clause begins with 'because'; Because he had walked all day in the Hajar Mountains, Omar was tired is also correct)
9. Because it was raining, we stayed inside. (Due to the fact that can be replaced by the single word because)
10. swooped (it shows how the falcon moved; went is general)
11. It is a dependent clause with no independent clause to finish the idea. Fix: Because the bus was late, we missed the start of the match. (or join it to a sentence before it)

12. A good answer has two independent clauses and at least one dependent clause. Model: When the tide went out, Khalid collected shells, and Noura built a sandcastle. (dependent: When the tide went out; independent: Khalid collected shells, Noura built a sandcastle)

Section 3: Writing

1. (b): it takes a side and gives a reason. (a) is only a statement of interest and cannot be argued.
2. A good answer takes a clear side and gives two different reasons. Model: Schools should plan one outdoor lesson each week because fresh air helps children concentrate and real places make science easier to understand.
3. (b): it is relevant and factual, and it explains why solar parks are good. (a) and (c) do not support the claim.
4. A good answer names the other side fairly and then responds. Model: Some people say an early start is tiring, but a later start would push the end of the school day into the hottest hours.
5. (b): it names the subject and tells the reader what the paragraph will explain.
6. Any suitable addition, such as In addition, Also or Furthermore. Model: Dates give quick energy. In addition, they contain fibre that helps digestion.
7. (3): it is not about how the metro works. All the details should support one topic.
8. Model: The weather was stormy, so many people stayed home. (an answer should drop slang and vague words and say what the weather was like)
9. A good plan names the character (Maryam), a setting (for example her grandmother's house), a problem (the chest holds something unexpected), and a line of dialogue in quotation marks with the speaker named. Answers will vary.
10. A good answer adds what the reader can see, hear, smell or touch. Model: The market buzzed with voices, and the smell of cardamom and fresh bread drifted between the crowded stalls.
11. A good answer returns to the main idea only. Model: These features show why camels survive so well in the desert.
12. A good answer gives two improvements, for example: give a stronger reason that links to the claim (such as time for rest, reading and family); support it with evidence or an example; answer the other side; and use a formal tone.